SCHEME OF WORK

Week	Topic
1	Revision of Last Term's Examination; Spelling: British and American English Basic Differences as Reflected in Common Words.
2	Comprehension: Prostration; Vocabulary Development: Festivals; Structure: Review of Noun Phrases and Noun Clauses, Adjectival Phrases and Adjectival Clauses; Writing: Review of Narrative and Descriptive Essays.
3	Speech Work: Review of Sentence Intonation Patterns; Writing: Argumentative Essay; Comprehension: Government; Summary: Party Systems.
4	Comprehension: Business; Vocabulary Development: Business; Structure: Nominalization; Speech Work: Monophthongs and Diphthongs.
5	Essay Writing: Formal and Informal Letters; Summary: Novel Extract; Structure: Adverbs and Adverbials.
6	Comprehension: Irrigation; Vocabulary Development: Technical Words; Structure: Sequence of Tenses; Speech Work: Clusters of Two Consonants Which Occur Initially and Finally.
7	Comprehension: Novel Extract; Vocabulary Development: French Words; Writing: Article Writing; Figures of Speech.
8	Comprehension: Law Enforcement; Vocabulary Development: Justice Delayed; Structure: Lexical and Auxiliary Verbs; Speech Work: More on Consonants.

Week	Topic
9	Comprehension: Law and Order; Vocabulary Development: Administration of Justice; Structure: More on Modals; Writing: More on Report Writing.
10	Comprehension: Helping Addicts; Vocabulary Development: Addiction; Speech Work: Stress in Words of Seven Syllables and in Compound Words.
11	Revision
12	Examination

COURSE CONTENT

WEEK 1

TOPICS: SPELLING: BRITISH AND AMERICAN ENGLISH

British vs. American Spelling Differences

Americans generally believe that a word should be spelt as it is pronounced. These basic differences are notable in several word categories:

- **'s' vs. 'z':**
  - specialisation -> specialization
  - colonise -> colonize
  - summarise -> summarize
  - organise -> organize
  - mechanise -> mechanize
  - economise -> economize
  - pressurise -> pressurize
  - centralise -> centralize
- **'our' vs. 'or':**
  - habour -> habor
  - honour -> honor
  - labour -> labor
  - neighbour -> neighbor
  - favour -> favor
  - vapour -> vapor
  - odour -> odor
- **'re' vs. 'er':**
  - centre -> center
  - metre -> meter
  - kilometre -> kilometer
- **'amme' vs. 'am':**

  - gramme -> gram
  - kilogramme -> kilogram
  - programme -> program
- **'ogue' vs. 'og':**
  - dialogue -> dialog
  - catalogue -> catalog
- **Doubling of 'l':** In verbs ending in 'l' that are not stressed on the final syllable, the 'l' is not doubled in the '-ing' form and past participle in American English.
  - travelling -> traveling
  - equalled -> equaled
  - cancelling -> canceling
- **'ae' / 'oe' vs. 'e':** Words of Greek and Latin origin retain the original spelling in British English, but are simplified in American English.
  - Haemoglobin -> hemoglobin
  - Diaerrhoea -> diarrhea
  - Encyclopaedia -> encyclopedia

WEEK 2

TOPICS: STRUCTURE: NOUN PHRASES AND NOUN CLAUSES; ADJECTIVAL PHRASES AND ADJECTIVAL CLAUSES; WRITING: NARRATIVE AND DESCRIPTIVE ESSAYS

Structure: Noun Phrases and Noun Clauses

A. Noun Phrase: A phrase in which the main word or the head is a noun or pronoun (e.g., the big ugly girl, a fat bank account, the man outside).

- **Functions:**
  - *As subject of a sentence:* The big girl is quarrelsome.
  - *As object of a verb:* The officer praised the students.
  - *As subject complement:* Our lecturer may become a commissioner.
  - *As object complement:* The grateful boy called his friend a saviour.
  - *As complement of a preposition:* The thief hid the gun under his bed.

B. Noun Clause: A subordinate clause that performs the functions of a noun.

- **Functions:**
  - *Subject of a sentence:* What he said is bitter.
  - *Object of a verb:* He told us that he would come.
  - *Complement of subject:* Honesty is what we want.
  - *Complement of object:* We call him what he likes.
  - *Complement of a preposition:* The prize will go to whoever wins.

Structure: Adjectival Phrases and Adjectival Clauses

A. Adjectival Phrase: A phrase which modifies a noun or pronoun.

- **Functions:**
  - *Attributive adjectives:* Fat men seldom run fast.
  - *Predicate adjectives:* Those questions are tough.
  - *Post-modifiers:* The boy with a brown cap is my class-mate.
  - *As nouns:* The rich are usually unmindful of the poor.

B. Adjectival Clause: A subordinate clause that performs the function of an adjective. It is usually introduced by conjunctions/pronouns like: who, whom, whose, that, which, where, when.

- **Examples:** The man who came here is a teacher. The house which has been renovated looks very new.

Writing: Narrative and Descriptive Essays

- **Narrative Essay:** Requires you to relate an event or incident as an eyewitness would. It is the art of story-telling. The narrative should follow chronological order, gradually moving to the climax. You must state the facts as they were and make it convincing.
- **Descriptive Essay:** Requires you to write a description of an object, a person, an animal, an incident, or a scene. You should have a very clear mental picture of what you want to describe to produce a clear, interesting, and informative description.

WEEK 3

TOPICS: SPEECH WORK: SENTENCE INTONATION PATTERNS; WRITING: ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY; SUMMARY: PARTY SYSTEMS

Speech Work: Sentence Intonation Patterns

Intonation and stress are vital in spoken English. The meaning of an utterance is affected by variations in the pitch of a voice.

- **Falling Tune:** Usually used in declarative sentences, commands, exclamations, and wh-questions.
  - *Statements:* Joy works hard in school.
  - *Commands:* Keep the books on my table.
  - *Wh-questions:* Why are you very late?
  - *Exclamations:* What a good result!
- **Rising Tune:** Used in Polar Questions (yes/no questions), utterances showing indifference, and listing items.
  - *Polar Questions:* Is the wine sweet?
  - *Indifference:* You can do what you want.
  - *Listing items:* One, two, three and four (the final item usually ends on a falling tune).
- **Combined Patterns:**
  - *Rise and fall:* While the boys were working, the girls were playing.
  - *Fall and rise:* The students are happy, aren't they?

Writing: Argumentative Essay

Requires you to present a subject with a view to persuading your reader to agree with your point of view against another one. It covers all forms of debate and may be developed to prove a point, present a viewpoint, or balance two sides of an issue.

- **Note:** All debates are argumentative essays, but not all argumentative essays are debates. Standard argumentative essays (non-debates) require you to write the topic and start writing your views without formally addressing an audience or greeting dignitaries.

Summary: Party Systems

- **One-party system:** Only one political party forms the government. Demerit: It tends to become too powerful with no checks.
- **Two-party system:** Two major parties exist. One rules while the other watches and checks the ruling party.
- **Multi-party system:** Allows as many parties as the electorate wishes. It is difficult for a party to emerge with an overall majority.

WEEK 4

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: BUSINESS; STRUCTURE: NOMINALIZATION; SPEECH WORK: MONOPHTHONGS AND DIPHTHONGS

Vocabulary Development: Business

Common words related to business operations include: trade, entrepreneurs, enterprises, factories, industries, apprentices, labourers, warehouse, stock, manager, export, retail, merchant, etc.

Structure: Nominalization

Nominalization is the process of forming nouns from other parts of speech.

- **Nouns formed from Adjectives:**
  - able -> ability
  - holy -> holiness
  - lazy -> laziness
  - clean -> cleanliness
  - bitter -> bitterness
  - dark -> darkness
  - warm -> warmth
  - wise -> wisdom
  - young -> youth
  - strong -> strength
  - poor -> poverty
  - ill -> illness
  - equal -> equality
- **Nouns formed from Verbs:**
  - repeat -> repetition
  - mix -> mixture
  - injure -> injury

- enjoy -> enjoyment
- bond -> bondage
- choose -> choice
- accuse -> accusation
- enter -> entrance
- differ -> difference
- hate -> hatred
- govern -> government
- endure -> endurance
- satisfy -> satisfaction
- think -> thought

Speech Work: Monophthongs and Diphthongs

Vowels in English are classified into pure vowels (monophthongs) and diphthongs.

- **Monophthongs:** 12 pure vowels (short and long).
  - /i:/ (beat, seat)
  - /i/ (bit, sit)
  - /e/ (bed, hen)
  - /æ/ (cart, part) **Note: typically short a as in cat/sat*
  - /a:/ (cart, part)
  - /ɔ/ (pot, cork)
  - /ɔ:/ (port, cork)
  - /u/ (put, foot)
  - /u:/ (two, woo)
  - /ʌ/ (hut, cut)
  - /3:/ (bird, herb)
  - /ə/ (akin, baker)
- **Diphthongs:** 8 vowels involving a glide from one quality to another.
  - /ei/ (pay, again)

- /əu/ (go, home)
- /ɑi/ (rice, kite)
- /au/ (cow, house)
- /ɔi/ (toy, voice)
- /iə/ (ear, here)
- /eə/ (air, hair)
- /uə/ (poor, tour)

WEEK 5

TOPICS: ESSAY WRITING: FORMAL AND INFORMAL LETTERS; STRUCTURE: ADVERBS AND ADVERBIALS

Essay Writing: Formal and Informal Letters

- **Formal Letters:** Written to people in official positions whom we may or may not know personally. Used for job applications, official queries, requests to government bodies, or letters to editors.
  - *Features:* Writer's address and date, Receiver's address, Salutation (Dear Sir/Madam), Heading or topic, Body of the letter, Complimentary close (Yours faithfully).
- **Informal Letters:** Private or personal letters written to parents, relatives, friends, or classmates.
  - *Features:* Writer's address and date, Salutation (Dear Eunice), Introduction, Body of the letter, Complimentary close (Yours sincerely).

Structure: Adverbs and Adverbials

An adverb is used to describe the action of a verb (how, where, or when it is done). Their main function is to modify verbs, but they also modify adjectives, other adverbs, and prepositional phrases.

- **Functions:**
  - *Modifier of verb:* Mary solved the problem *quickly*.
  - *Modifier of adjective:* Peter is *very* tall.
  - *Modifier of another adverb:* Bunmi runs *extremely* fast.
  - *Modifier of prepositional phrase:* The girl slapped Tom *right* in the face.

WEEK 6

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: TECHNICAL WORDS; STRUCTURE: SEQUENCE OF TENSES; SPEECH WORK: CONSONANT CLUSTERS

Vocabulary Development: Technical Words (Irrigation)

Words related to irrigation systems include: equipment, fields, hydraulic, trench, regions, tropical, sub-tropical, sprinkler, nozzles, etc.

Structure: Sequence of Tenses

Ensure logical tense progression. (e.g., In 1982, PZ's Managing Director, Basil Sponddeas, who *had spent* his entire life working in the company, *retired*. He *was succeeded* by George Loupos.)

Speech Work: Consonant Clusters

A consonant cluster occurs when two or more consonants follow each other without an intervening vowel. They can appear initially or finally.

- **Hidden /j/ sounds:** Sometimes not obvious from spelling:
  - new /nju:/
  - few /fju:/
  - cute /kju:t/
  - tune /tju:n/
  - view /vju:/
  - student /stju:dənt/
- **Initial Clusters:** play /plei/, bright /brait/, drain /drein/, threat /θret/, clan /klæn/, hew /hju:/.
- **Final Clusters:** Sacked /sækt/, Washed /wɔst/, Marks /ma:ks/, Maps /mæps/, Lanes /leinz/, Loaves /ləuvz/.

WEEK 7

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: FRENCH WORDS; WRITING: ARTICLES; FIGURES OF SPEECH

Vocabulary Development: French Words

French is one of the European languages developed from Latin. Several expressions are commonly used in English:

- **á la carte:** Part of a menu where each dish is listed with its price.
- **Á la mode:** Fashionable.
- **Bourgeoisie:** The middle class.
- **Chef:** Senior cook.
- **Communiqué:** An official announcement.
- **Déjà vu:** Seen before.
- **Fiancé:** A man who is engaged to be married.
- **Malaise:** An uneasy feeling.
- **Gauche:** Socially clumsy or inept.
- **Précis:** A summary.
- **RSVP:** Repondez s'il vous plait ("please reply"). Placed at the foot of formal invitations.

Writing: Articles

Articles are expository essays that fully explain a thing or process, often for publication in a newspaper or magazine. It distinguishes the subject and may involve description.

- **Sample Structure:** Introduction (Observation), Explaining the problem, First major result, Second major result, Conclusion (The need to solve the problem).

Figures of Speech

A departure from the literal use of a word or phrase.

- **Simile:** Indirect comparison using 'like' or 'as' (e.g., Peter is as cunny as a snake).
- **Metaphor:** Direct comparison without 'like' or 'as' (e.g., Peter is a snake).

- **Personification:** Transferring living qualities to non-living things (e.g., The sun smiled at me).
- **Euphemism:** Presenting an unpleasant thing in a palatable way (e.g., The old man has kicked the bucket).
- **Irony:** The literal meaning is the opposite of the intended meaning (e.g., He jokingly describes the midget as a 'very tall' person).
- **Paradox:** A statement that appears contradictory but contains an important truth (e.g., Attack is the best form of defence).
- **Pun:** A play on words with similar sounds but different meanings (e.g., The dead drunkard was laid on his *bier*).
- **Onomatopoeia:** Words formed in imitation of actual sounds (e.g., The hiss of a snake).

WEEK 8

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: JUSTICE; STRUCTURE: LEXICAL AND AUXILIARY VERBS; SPEECH WORK: MORE ON CONSONANTS

Vocabulary Development: Justice

Words related to law enforcement and justice include: investigation, punishment, plaintiff, sentence, trial, legal, judge, etc.

Structure: Lexical and Auxiliary Verbs

- **Lexical Verbs (Main Verbs):** Can stand alone as the verb element of the sentence (e.g., Dike *did* the work yesterday; We *are* students). If there is more than one verb, the lexical verb appears last.
- **Auxiliary Verbs:** Help main verbs perform their functions.
  - **Primary Auxiliaries:** *be, do, have.* They can also function as main verbs. (e.g., I *am* going to school).
  - **Modal Auxiliaries:** Cannot be used as main verbs. Examples: *can, could, may, might, shall, will, should, would, must, ought to, used to, need, dare.*

Speech Work: Consonants

There are 24 speech consonants in English, classified by place of articulation, manner of articulation, and state of the glottis (voiced/voiceless).

- **Stops (Plosives):** /p/ (pan), /b/ (bud), /t/ (tea), /d/ (dip), /k/ (come), /g/ (get).
- **Fricatives:** /f/ (fork), /v/ (van), /θ/ (think), /ð/ (this), /s/ (sip), /z/ (zink), /ʃ/ (ship), /ʒ/ (genre), /h/ (hat).
- **Affricates:** /tʃ/ (cheap), /dʒ/ (joy).
- **Lateral:** /l/ (lock).
- **Liquid/Approximant:** /r/ (rag).
- **Semi-Vowels:** /w/ (win), /j/ (yes).
- **Nasals:** /m/ (man), /n/ (net), /ŋ/ (singer).

WEEK 9

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: ADMINISTRATION OF JUSTICE; STRUCTURE: MODAL AUXILIARIES; WRITING: REPORT WRITING

Vocabulary Development: Administration of Justice

Words associated with law and order: lawyer, legal, court, defence, convicted, sentenced, remanded, appeal, enforcement, charges, criminal, discharge, remand, etc.

Structure: Modal Auxiliaries

There are 13 modal auxiliaries: can, could, may, might, shall, should, will, would, must, ought to, used to, need, dare.

- **can/could:** Permission, possibility, ability, capacity.
- **may/might:** Permission, possibility.
- **shall/will:** Simple futurity, determination, order, willingness.
- **should:** Obligation, logical necessity, condition.
- **would:** Habitual action in the past, polite request, probability.
- **must:** Obligation in present/future, logical necessity.
- **ought to:** Obligation (equivalent to should), expectation.
- **used to:** Habitual action in the past.
- **need:** Absence of obligation (in negative sentences).
- **dare:** Negative sentences and questions (e.g., Nobody dare insult our leader).

Writing: Report Writing

A report is an account of an event that has taken place. The approach depends on the audience. A formal report (e.g., of a robbery, accident, or meeting proceedings) is presented as an official document.

- **Format:** Date, Recipient Address, Salutation, Title/Subject, Body of Report, Sign-off with Name and Role.

WEEK 10

TOPICS: VOCABULARY: ADDICTION; SPEECH WORK: STRESS IN SEVEN-SYLLABLE WORDS AND COMPOUND WORDS

Vocabulary Development: Addiction

Words related to drug addiction and rehabilitation: medicines, injections, trafficker, addict, cocaine, heroin, drug, crave, illegal, psychotherapist, distractions, etc.

Speech Work: Stress in Words of Seven Syllables and Compound Words

- **Words of Seven Syllables:** Often ending in '-ity', the stress falls heavily on the syllable containing 'BIL'.
  - In-de-fen-si-BIL-i-ty
  - In-di-spen-sa-BIL-i-ty
  - In-di-vis-i-BIL-i-ty
  - Im-pen-e-tra-BIL-i-ty
  - Im-per-me-a-BIL-i-ty
  - In-ad-miss-i-BIL-i-ty
  - In-a-ccess-i-BIL-i-ty
- **Compound Words:** Stress placement can vary depending on the word type, but emphasis is clear in spoken English.
  - absent-MINDed
  - Action-packed
  - back-DOOR
  - blue-CHIP
  - Bottle-feed
  - FLY-by